

Leonard Eckert

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PROFILE

Detail-oriented technologist with hands-on QA and software testing experience, including freelance crowdtesting for Applause (uTest) across numerous mobile app and web platform projects, plus prior roles in professional test execution and crowd test evaluation. Passionate about music, gadgets, and emerging tech, with a strong software engineering foundation from an IHK-certified apprenticeship, a Data Science degree, and eight international internships with IBM Research and IBM Client Engineering. Currently working as a Data Engineer at Bosch Research while pursuing a Master's degree in AI and Linguistics at Stockholm University.

TESTING & QA EXPERIENCE

Freelance Software Tester

2021 – 2022

Applause (uTest)

Remote

- Performed functional and exploratory testing of mobile and web applications across numerous crowdtesting projects for international clients
- Identified, documented, and tracked software bugs with detailed reproduction steps and severity assessments
- Designed and executed test cases covering functional, usability, and regression scenarios

QA Engineer (Fulltime Role)

Apr. 2019 – Aug. 2019

Unitymedia via Proadapt Solutions Pvt. Ltd.

Cologne, Germany

- Test execution and test planning for a B2B platform
- Testing internal tools with IBM AS400
- Created a resource planning tool with Excel and VBA

Project Management Intern

Oct. 2018 – Mar. 2019

Testbirds GmbH

Munich, Germany

- Completed crowd test evaluation, including a presentation of the results to clients
- Template development in Excel and with Power BI and R

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Testing & QA: Manual & Exploratory Testing, Bug Tracking, Test Case Design, Crowdtesting

Languages & Frameworks: Java, Python, C, SQL, R, Spring Boot, React.js, LangChain

Cloud & Tools: Databricks, Apache Spark, Azure, Bicep, OpenShift, Docker, Git, Linux, Neo4j, GraphQL, Kafka

EDUCATION

Stockholm University

Stockholm, Sweden

Master of Science, AI and Linguistics

Aug. 2026 – Aug. 2028

- Coursework spans computational linguistics, machine learning, and language technology
- Builds on Bachelor's thesis work on NLP agents and semantic alignment for natural language generation

DHBW Stuttgart

Stuttgart, Germany

Bachelor of Science, Business Information Systems (Data Science)

Sep. 2022 – Sep. 2025

- Dual/cooperative study program: alternated academic terms with practical placements at IBM
- Thesis: Design and Implementation of a Semantic Alignment Agent for Natural Language Generation (1.4 German GPA, top 10% of the year)

Karlstad University

Karlstad, Sweden

Exchange Semester

Jan. 2024 – June 2024

Deutsches Elektronen-Synchrotron (DESY)

Hamburg, Germany

IHK-Certified Vocational Apprenticeship, Computer Science Expert (Software Development)

Sep. 2019 – July 2022

- Dual vocational training combining vocational-school coursework with on-the-job work as a Junior Java Developer at this physics research institute
- Development of a distributed file system for scientific data, dCache, in Java
- Exams passed with excellent grades (93%), top 5% of the year

WORK EXPERIENCE

Data Engineer

Bosch Research

Sep. 2025 – Now
Stuttgart, Germany

- Developed and maintained a Databricks data pipeline written in Python
- Built a high-performance Apache Spark application processing over 30 billion records while reliably parsing MF4 files
- Supported the infrastructure team with platform development in MS Azure using Bicep

INTERNSHIPS

IBM Client Engineering

Intern – Vienna, Austria

June 2025 – Sep. 2025

- Developed an innovative agent-based demo using WatsonX Orchestrate for partner enablement
- Performed advanced data analysis using Python to process and extract insights from complex datasets

Intern – Singapore

Sep. 2024 – Nov. 2024

- Built and deployed a containerized application on OpenShift to analyze JVM garbage collector memory allocation in Java
- Created presentation materials for client-facing workshops

Intern – Stuttgart Ehningen, Germany

Dec. 2022 – Mar. 2023

- Built multiple prototypes for Watson OpenScale to monitor LLM performance on IBM Cloud Pak for Data
- Deployed a demo cluster on OpenShift in a successful client engagement
- Collaborated with an offshore team in India to troubleshoot and resolve issues

IBM Research

Research Intern – Dublin, Ireland

Feb. 2025 – May 2025

- High focus on development of the NLP agent for my Bachelor thesis
- Developed a custom LangChain component integrating LLaMA, DeepSeek, and Granite models into a unified interface

Research Intern – Dublin, Ireland

June 2024 – Sep. 2024

- Designed and implemented a smart evaluation framework for Large Language Models, focusing on tailored performance metrics in Python
- Containerized and deployed the application for scalable and reproducible execution

Research Intern – Zürich Rüschlikon, Switzerland

June 2023 – Sep. 2023

- Implemented a custom schema for polymorphic GraphQL in Java
- Built a small demo in Neo4j to model and visualize a knowledge graph
- Modified an existing Kafka consumer to improve data processing efficiency

IBM Consulting

Intern

Wilhelmshaven, Germany
Nov. 2023 – Jan. 2024

- Contributed to a SASPF (SAP Bundeswehr solution) project for the German Navy
- Supported a project to improve material readiness and availability

SELECTED PROJECTS

Hippo Codes

2024 – present

- Full-stack development of a game addressing the consequences of climate change
- Sole developer responsible for the complete implementation, including the CI/CD pipeline – hippo-codes.com

Semantix

Nov. 2024 – Feb. 2025

- Built a German word-guessing minigame leveraging word embeddings with vector search powered by Pinecone
- Deployed using Vercel – semantix-green.vercel.app

EveryOneCounts.de (Founded after a hackathon against the covid pandemic)

Mar. 2020 – Aug. 2020

- Visualized social distancing in the corona pandemic using multiple data sources
- Project went viral and I talked about it in the media – [Tagesschau feature](#)
- Developed a prototype to count customers in public spaces using 3D printing and an ESP32 in C

LANGUAGES

German – native speaker, English – business fluent, Swedish – beginner

ADDITIONAL

Volunteering: Working as a trained paramedic at events (03/2016 – 02/2020)

Interests: Machine learning, 3D printing, economics, photography, flight simulation, skiing

Driver's license: German driver's license Class B (Cars)